# Nimbus Orbit Technologies Pvt. Ltd.

HR Policies Handbook | Leave, Benefits, Performance and Conduct

Policy owner: Chief People Officer (Meera Nambiar) | Version 5.1 | Effective: 1 April 2026 | Next review: 1 April 2027 | Contact: people@nimbusorbit.example.com

## 1. Purpose and Scope

This handbook defines employment policies for all full-time and part-time employees of Nimbus Orbit Technologies Pvt. Ltd. Interns and contractors are covered by Section 14 only. Nimbus Orbit is an equal opportunity employer and does not discriminate on the basis of gender, caste, religion, disability, age, marital status, sexual orientation, or any other protected characteristic.

## 2. Working Hours and Work Model

- Standard working hours are 9:30 AM to 6:30 PM IST, Monday to Friday, with a one-hour lunch break.
- Core collaboration hours are 11:00 AM to 4:00 PM IST, during which employees are expected to be reachable.
- The default work model is **hybrid**: three days in office (Tuesday, Wednesday, Thursday) and two days remote.
- Fully remote work requires written approval from the department head and the HR business partner.
- Employees working from another city for more than 15 days in a year must notify HR for tax and compliance reasons.

## 3. Leave Policy

| Leave type | Entitlement per year | Notes |
|---|---|---|
| Annual (earned) leave | 20 working days | Accrues monthly; up to 30 days can be carried forward to the next year |
| Sick leave | 10 working days | Medical certificate required for absences of 3 or more consecutive days |
| Casual leave | 7 working days | Cannot be carried forward; maximum 3 days at a time |
| Maternity leave | 26 weeks | As per the Maternity Benefit Act; applies to the first two children |
| Paternity leave | 10 working days | To be taken within 6 months of the child's birth or adoption |
| Bereavement leave | 5 working days | For death of an immediate family member |
| Marriage leave | 5 working days | One-time, for the employee's own marriage |
| Volunteer leave | 2 working days | For approved social causes, paid |
| Loss of pay (LOP) | Unpaid | Applies once all paid leave is exhausted |

Leave requests must be submitted in the HR portal (PeopleHub) at least 3 working days in advance for planned leave of up to 3 days, and at least 2 weeks in advance for leave longer than 5 days. Sick leave must be reported to the reporting manager before 10:00 AM on the first day of absence. Encashment of unused annual leave is allowed only at separation, up to 30 days, calculated on basic salary.

**Public holidays:** The company observes 12 public holidays per year, published each December for the following calendar year. Employees may also choose 2 optional (floating) holidays from a published list of 8.

# 4. Compensation and Benefits

## 4.1 Salary and payroll

Salaries are paid on the last working day of each month by bank transfer. The annual compensation cycle runs from April, with revised salaries effective 1 April. Compensation comprises fixed pay (basic salary, house rent allowance, special allowance), a variable bonus for eligible roles, and employer contributions to the Provident Fund (12% of basic salary).

## 4.2 Benefits

| Benefit | Details |
|---|---|
| Group health insurance | INR 5 lakh cover for employee, spouse, and up to 2 children; premium paid by company. Parents can be added at a 50% employee contribution. |
| Group term life insurance | 4 times annual fixed salary, up to INR 1 crore |
| Accidental cover | INR 25 lakh |
| Learning budget | INR 40,000 per employee per year for courses, books, and certifications |
| Wellness allowance | INR 1,500 per month, reimbursable against gym, yoga, or mental-health sessions |
| Home-office setup | One-time allowance of INR 15,000 for chair, desk, or monitor |
| Internet reimbursement | INR 1,000 per month for remote and hybrid employees |
| Employee assistance programme | Free, confidential counselling: 6 sessions per year per person |
| Referral bonus | INR 30,000 for each successful referral after the new hire completes 6 months |

# 5. Expense Reimbursement and Travel

- Expense claims must be filed within 30 days of the expense, with original receipts, in the PeopleHub portal.
- Domestic air travel is economy class; international travel is economy for flights under 6 hours and premium economy above 6 hours.
- Hotel limits per night: INR 7,000 in metro cities, INR 4,500 in other cities, and USD 180 internationally.
- Daily meal allowance during travel is INR 1,200 domestically and USD 50 internationally.
- Claims over INR 25,000 need approval from the department head; claims over INR 1,00,000 need CFO approval.

# 6. Performance Management

Nimbus Orbit runs a half-yearly performance cycle. The first review period is April to September, with conversations held in October; the second is October to March, with conversations held in April. Employees set 3 to 5 objectives using the OKR framework in the first month of each cycle.

| Rating | Label | Description |
|---|---|---|
| 5 | Outstanding | Consistently exceeds expectations and raises the performance of the team |
| 4 | Exceeds expectations | Frequently goes beyond goals |
| 3 | Meets expectations | Fully delivers on goals and role requirements |
| 2 | Needs improvement | Partially meets goals; a development plan is created |
| 1 | Unsatisfactory | Does not meet expectations; triggers a 60-day performance improvement plan (PIP) |

## 7. Career Framework

Engineering and product roles follow levels L1 to L8: L1-L2 (Associate), L3 (Engineer), L4 (Senior Engineer), L5 (Staff Engineer or Lead), L6 (Principal or Manager), L7 (Director), L8 (VP). Promotions are reviewed twice a year, aligned with the performance cycle. A minimum of 18 months in level is typically expected before a promotion, though exceptional performance may shorten this.

## 8. Onboarding and Probation

- New employees complete a 5-day orientation covering company products, security training, and culture.
- The probation period is 6 months for all new hires. It may be extended by up to 3 months.
- Each new hire is assigned an onboarding buddy for the first 90 days.
- Mandatory training to complete within 30 days: information security awareness, POSH (prevention of sexual harassment), and code of conduct.

## 9. Code of Conduct

All employees must act with integrity, protect confidential information, and avoid conflicts of interest. Gifts from vendors or customers valued above INR 3,000 must be declared to the compliance officer, and gifts of cash are never acceptable. Employees must not work for a competitor or engage in outside work that conflicts with company interests without prior written approval. Use of company data for personal gain is prohibited.

## 10. Anti-Harassment (POSH) Policy

Nimbus Orbit has zero tolerance for sexual harassment, in line with the Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace Act, 2013. The Internal Committee (IC) is chaired by Priya Raghavan, Senior Director of Operations. Complaints may be raised at ic@nimbusorbit.example.com. The IC acknowledges complaints within 3 working days and completes inquiries within 90 days. Retaliation against complainants is a serious violation.

## 11. Disciplinary Process

| Step | Action | When applied |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Verbal counselling | Minor first-time breach |
| 2 | Written warning | Repeated minor breach or moderate first-time breach |

| Step | Action | When applied |
|---|---|---|
| 3 | Suspension without pay (up to 15 days) | Serious breach pending or following inquiry |
| 4 | Termination for cause | Severe misconduct: fraud, harassment, data theft, violence, or repeated violations |

## 12. Resignation and Separation

The notice period is 60 days for L1 to L5 and 90 days for L6 and above. During probation, the notice period is 30 days. The company may waive or buy out part of the notice period at its discretion. Full and final settlement is paid within 45 days of the last working day. Exit interviews are conducted by HR during the final week. Gratuity is payable after 5 years of continuous service, as per the Payment of Gratuity Act.

## 13. Grievance Redressal

Employees can raise concerns in this order: (1) reporting manager, (2) HR business partner, (3) Chief People Officer at people@nimbusorbit.example.com. An anonymous ethics hotline is available at +91-80-5550-1999 and through ethics@nimbusorbit.example.com. All reports are investigated within 30 days.

## 14. Interns and Contractors

Interns receive a monthly stipend between INR 20,000 and INR 35,000 depending on the programme and are not eligible for paid leave except 1 day per month of internship. Contractors are governed by their service agreements and must follow the code of conduct and information security policy.

## 15. Frequently Asked Questions

**Q: How many annual leave days do employees get?**

A: 20 working days per year, with up to 30 days carry-forward.

**Q: What is the notice period for a Senior Engineer (L4)?**

A: 60 days.

**Q: What is the hybrid work schedule?**

A: Three days in office (Tuesday to Thursday) and two remote days.

**Q: How much is the yearly learning budget?**

A: INR 40,000 per employee.

**Q: When are performance reviews held?**

A: Twice a year: conversations in October and April.

**Q: How long is the probation period?**

A: 6 months, extendable by up to 3 months.